Lappeenrannan teknillinen yliopisto
School of Business and Management

Sofware Development Skills

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LEARNING DIARY, FRONT END MODULE

LEARNING DIARY

29.5.2022

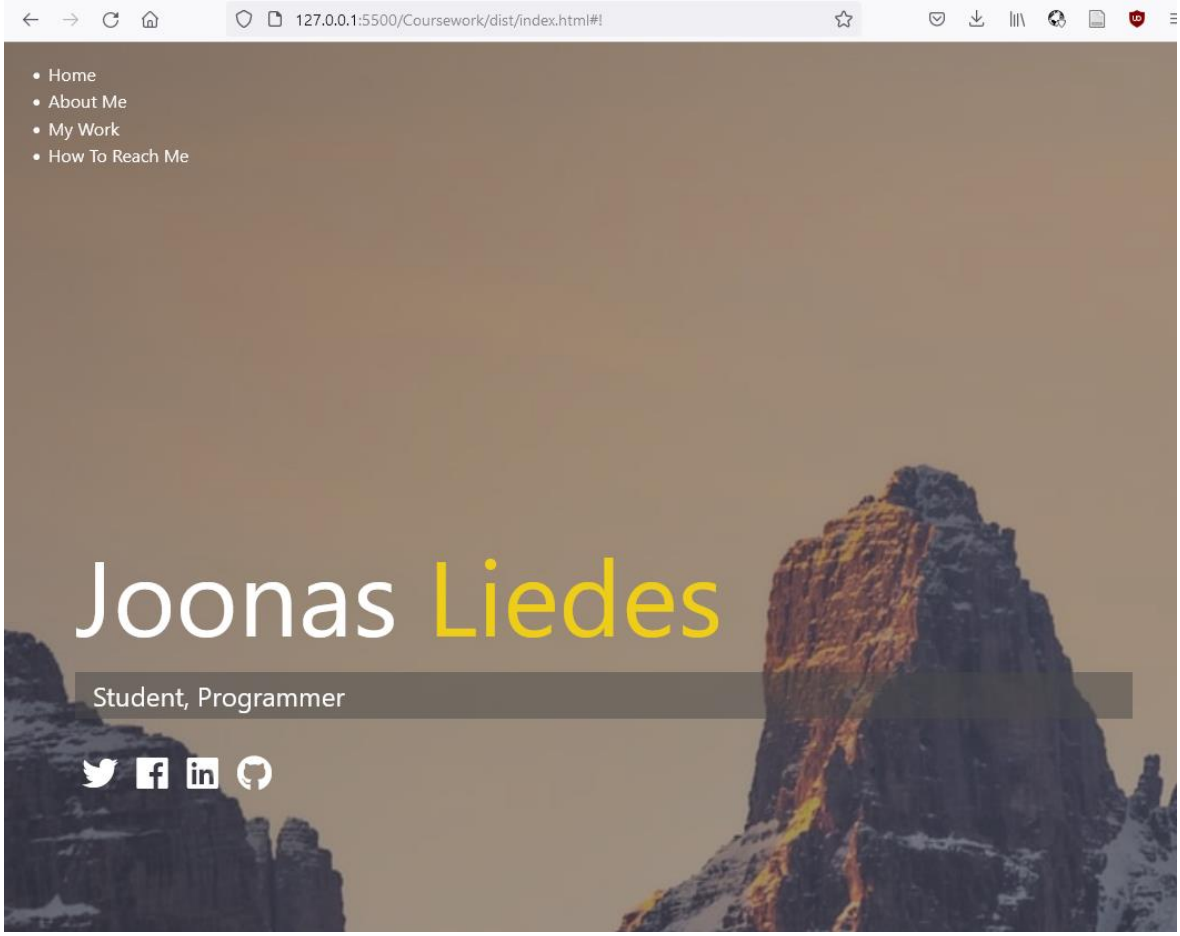
I enrolled and read through the administrative information of the course. After getting orientated, I installed Node as instructed in the first lecture. I've been using Git prior to this course, so I skipped that part. Lately I've been using GitHub desktop for its convenience. My code editor of choice is Vs Code, as it is fast and offers lots of handy extensions. I also like its integrated terminal. I then proceeded to install the recommended extensions (Prettier and Live server) for this course. Then, I continued to complete the first simple sass task and committed the materials under 'Coursework' in my GitHub repository.

This first task was quite straight forward, and everything went smoothly. Today I learned that Sass is basically an extension of CSS that allows scripting and variables etc to avoid repetition and makes the code more efficient. Sass has been implemented in multiple languages, and in the context of this course npm's node-sass is used.

30.5.2022 – Part 1

Today I proceeded to watch the second part of the lecture series and completed the core of my responsive web site according to the video's instructions. The video is a couple of years old, so the icon implementation wasn't as straight forward as in the video. Sign in is nowadays required in fontawesome.com, though a workaround for this could be found through the GitHub repository of the video's maker. As I haven't done much of front-end work, much of the videos content besides the basic html was new to me. I learned a lot about Sass and quickly noticed its value when using variables and nesting to simplify the process of CSS based design.

Screenshot of the site after part 1:



30.5.2022 – Part 2

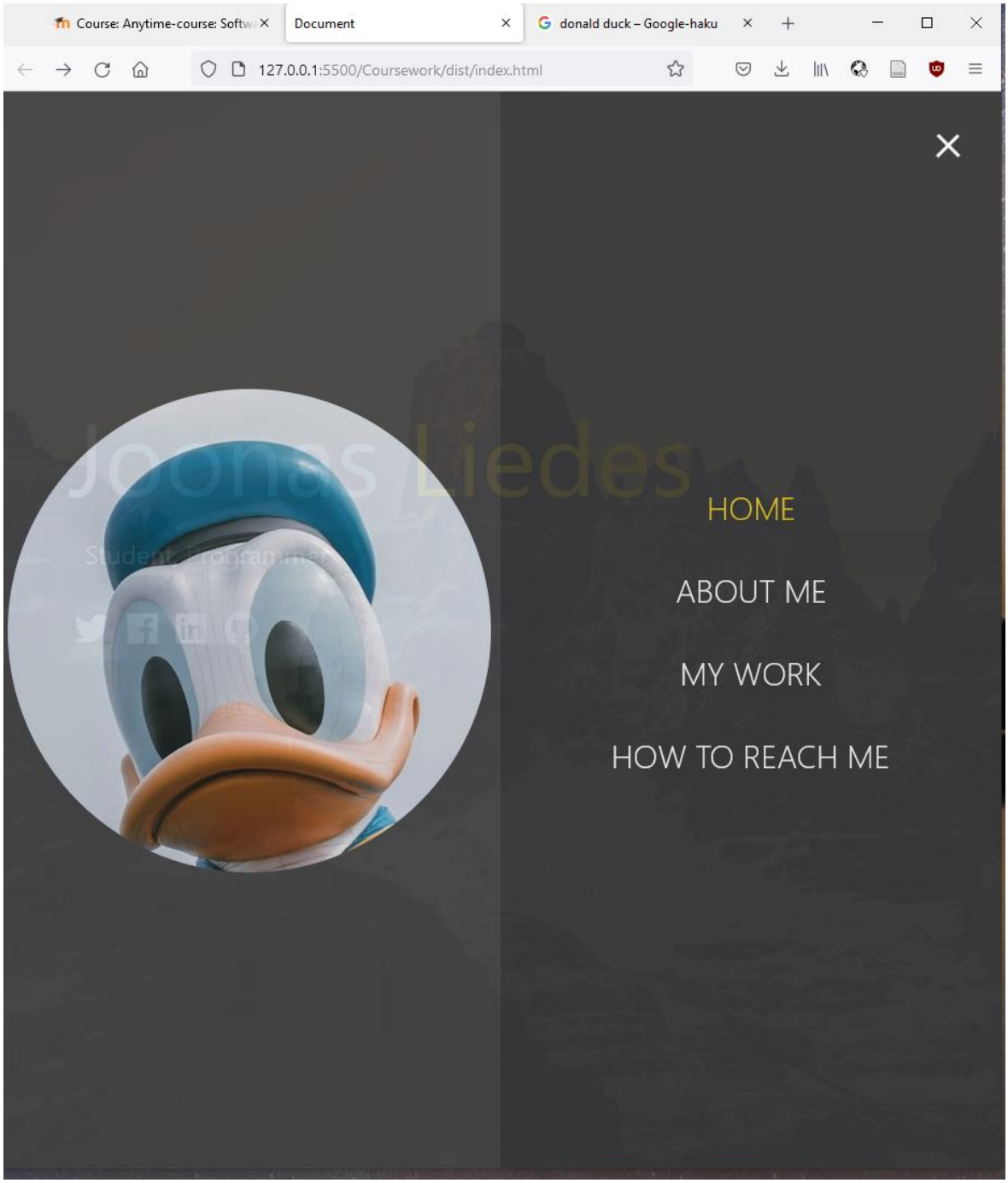
I continued working with the third lecture and created the menu button and the JavaScript to operate the transition between the tree menu lines and the X-symbol. As I haven't done much of JavaScript the syntax wasn't that familiar and arrow functions seemed odd add first, but after a bit of studying they seem quite intuitive.

Screenshot of site after Part 2:

31.5.2022

Today I continued with the fourth part of the series and created the basic overlay for the menu. The syntax for the Sass for-loop was new for me and seemed weird at first. Other than that, creating the overlay went nicely. Although, to get the ‘Home’ item in the menu to be of the secondary color, I had to add the ‘current’ to the home-tag in the index.html. I also had to do a bit of experimenting with the portrait to get it aligned properly. I also learned about Sass’ mixins that help write more reusable code, since I don’t have to rewrite the screen size parameters for example when creating the responsive functionality to the site.

Screenshot of the medium size version after today:

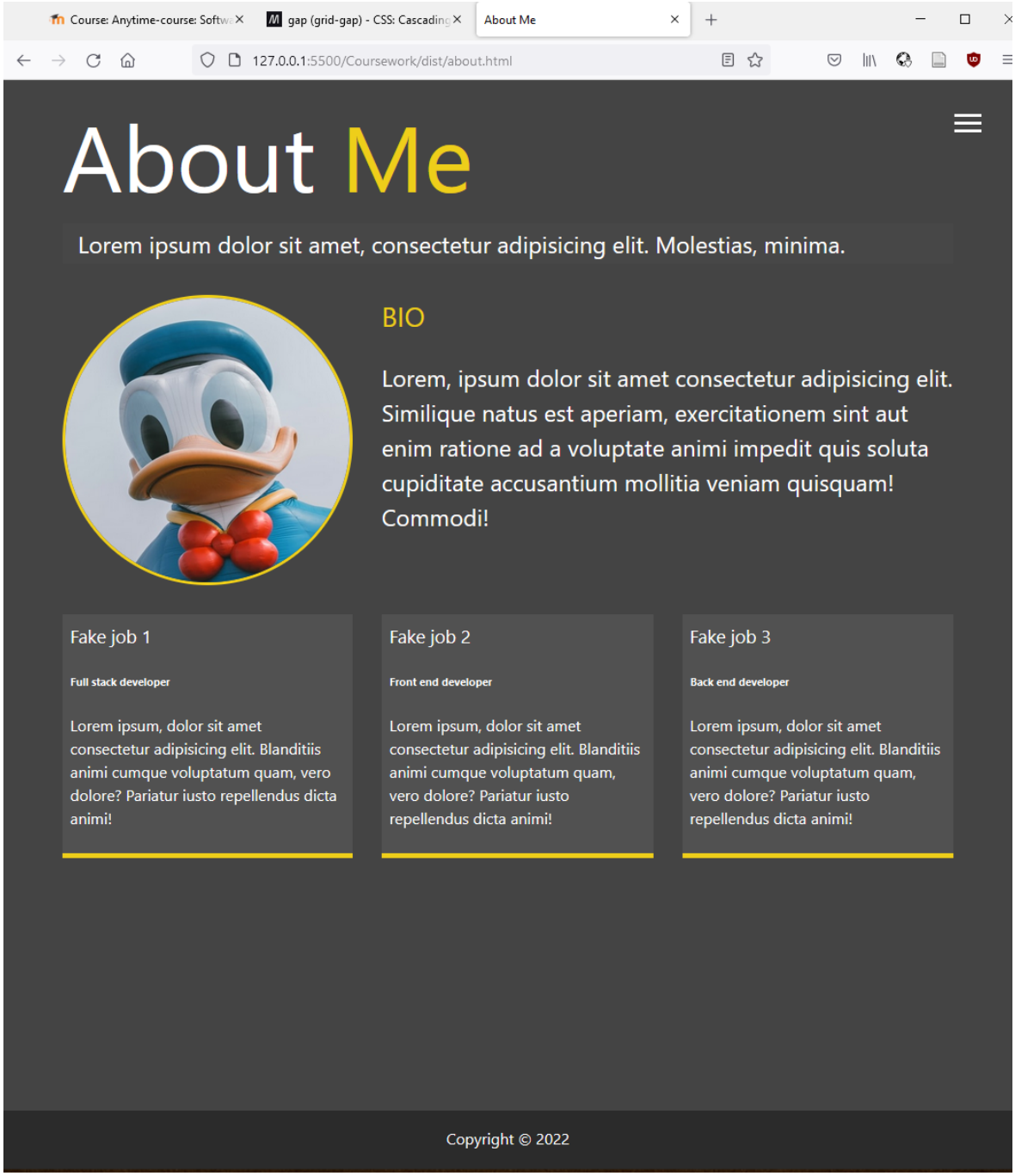


1.6.2022 – Part 1

In this part of the series I created the About Me page adding a new html file and the Sass-script to go along with it. The single most important lesson in this part for me was the use of grids to make the sites layout nice and clean. Initially I had a bit of problems getting the job descriptions to fit symmetrically, as my portrait picture was quite large, and the example code didn't account for this. I worked around it by setting the height and width parameters

for the image. The grids came in handy also when adding the responsiveness in the mobile version.

Screenshot after this part:

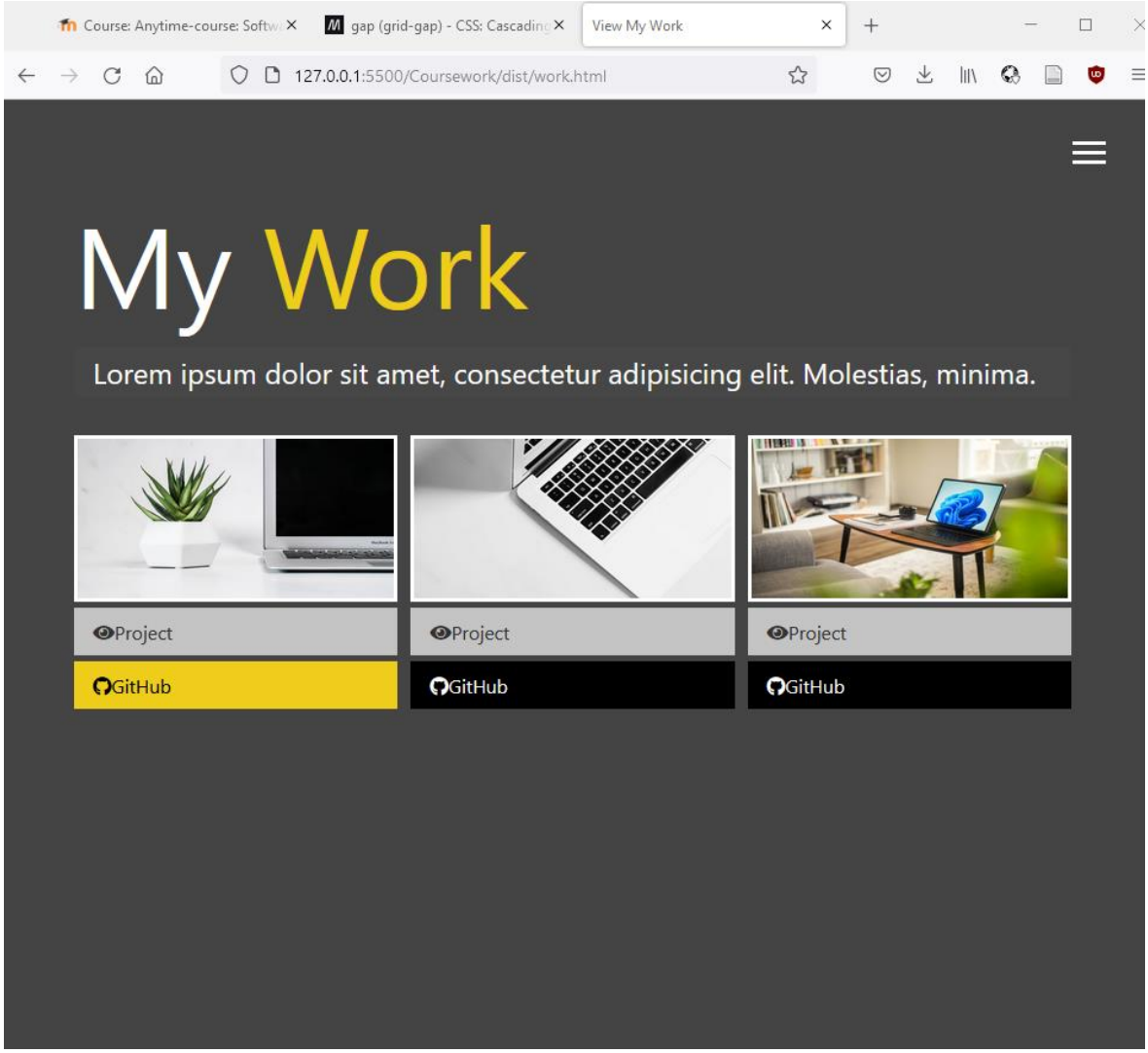


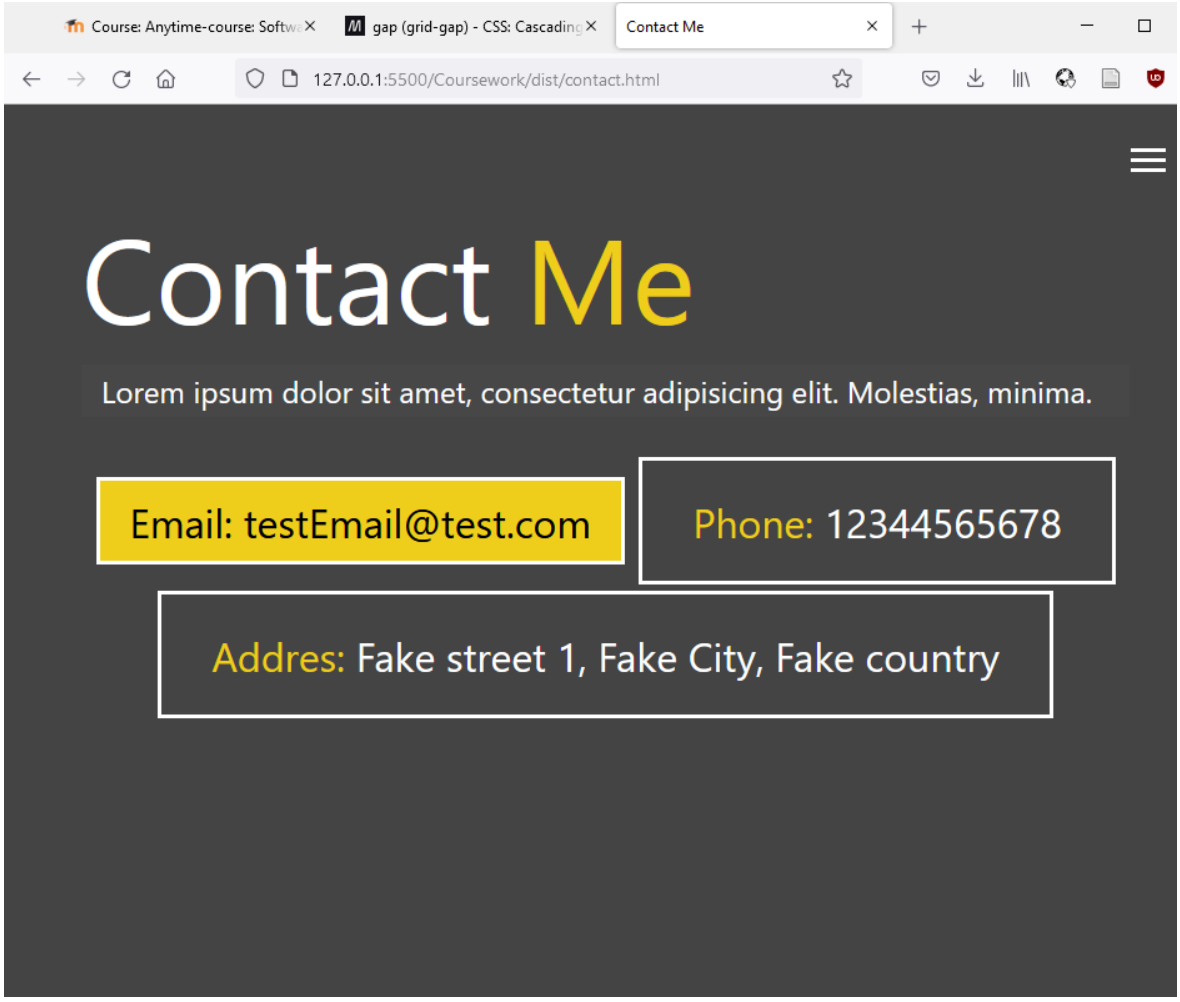
1.6.2022 – Part 2

I continued to the sixth lesson and completed the work and contact pages for the website. The work page was implemented by using the same grid structure as in the about me section.

The contact section was done using the Flexbox utility. In the work section I had chosen some random images that weren't the same size, so I had to add a height parameter to the images in order to make them symmetrical.

Screenshots of the pages:





2.6.2022

The last part was about deploying the site using GitHub pages. I had some issues with this, as I had already made my commits and pushed them to an existing repository. In addition, I also have two different GitHub accounts and for this reason I had some trouble with Git's credential manager when I tried to solve the problem by pushing the initial repository directly to a new repository with the .io suffix. Instead of fighting with Git, I created a new public repository with the name j00lie,github.io as per GitHubs instructions and copied only the deployable files there from the 'dist' directory of the original repository. There might be a more straight forward solution to deploying pages from an existing repository, but I couldn't get them to work even though I followed GitHubs instructions for this. Anyway here's the screenshot from the finished site deployed with my approach:

j00lie/j00lie.github.io: Deployab
Home
https://j00lie.github.io/index.html
Joonas Liedes
Student, Programmer

10.6.2022

Today I completed my personal project that’s based on the coursework materials. I made some changes to the outlook of the site, mainly color changes and formatting of the images and responsiveness. In addition, I added some functionality to the contact page, so that visitors can effortlessly send emails to me just by clicking on the email address. I did this by using the html’s ‘mailto’ property. I also added a leaflet map for convenience, and to give the contact page a bit nicer outlook.